The Modern Fourth Way — Audiobook Companion

This companion accompanies the audiobook edition of The Modern Fourth Way *by Jeremy Simon (Modern Fourth Way Publishing, 2026; revised October 2026). It contains the book's diagrams, referenced by the narration, and the complete glossary of the Work.*

The Diagrams

1 Man number one — centered in the body . . . 3
2 Man number two — centered in feeling . . . 4
3 Man number three — centered in thought . . . 5
4 Man number four — the machine under observation . . . 6
5 Man number five — unity and the permanent 'I' . . . 7
6 Man number six — the threshold . . . 8
7 Man number seven — the machine after crystallization . . . 9
8 The enneagram: circle, triangle, and hexad . . . 10
9 The food octave on the enneagram . . . 11

Glossary

Every technical term of the Fourth Way used in the book, in alphabetical order.

A, B, and C influences — The three kinds of influence acting on every life: A influences arise inside ordinary life (money, status, security) and lead back into it; B influences originate outside ordinary life and reach us diluted (genuine teachings, sacred art); C influence is direct, undiluted contact with a living teaching.

Aim — The consciously chosen goal that organizes the Work. The daily renewal of aim is itself a practice — the shock that keeps the master octave of your work from bending.

Alarm clocks — Ordinary recurring events (doorways, red lights, the phone's buzz) deliberately appointed as reminders to self-remember. Rotated regularly, because the machine automates any single alarm within weeks.

Buffers — Automatic psychological shock-absorbers that keep our contradictory I's from ever colliding in awareness, preserving the illusion of one consistent person. Merciful — and the reason a buffered machine cannot change. The bodyguards of chief feature.

Carriage, horse, driver, and master — Gurdjieff's image of the human being: body as carriage, emotions as untrained horse, mind as sleeping driver — and the master's seat empty. The Work is the process by which the master returns to the carriage. Modern rig, same emptiness: the self-driving car circling flawlessly with no destination entered — the owner asleep aboard.

Center of gravity — The center a person lives from by default — the processor that receives experience first and gets the most energy. Determines the three basic human types. In Bennett's dynamic sense: where the sense of "I" currently resides — and transformation is its relocation, from the surface machinery toward the depth of oneself.

Centers — The distinct processors of the human machine: intellectual, emotional, moving, instinctive, and sex, plus the two higher centers. Each has its own speed, its own kind of work, and its own way of malfunctioning.

Chief feature — The single central habit around which the entire personality is organized — the axle everything else turns on. Specifically defended against self-observation; visible to your friends, invisible to you.

The churn — The intellectual center's idle state: thought running with no destination, the same loops recycling, commentary for its own sake. A major energy leak.

Conscience — Not the learned, cultural voice of "should" (which belongs to personality), but an innate faculty, identical in every human being: the capacity to FEEL, all at once, the whole truth about oneself. Its awakening is the fire that fuses the many I's into one.

Conscious labor — Doing the work that needs doing — the job, the dishes, the morning dog walk — with someone present: both arrows, the task and the one doing it. Not productivity, not absorption, not grim duty. With self-remembering and intentional suffering, one of the three pillars of the Work.

Crystallization — The process by which something in a person's being becomes permanent and no longer dissolves under ordinary conditions. Begins at man number five.

The dream — The direct path's word for the same condition the Work calls sleep: living inside the story in your head, mistaking it for reality.

Enneagram — The tradition's master diagram: a circle (the octave), a triangle (the three forces, touching the circle at the intervals), and an inner hexad (the hidden circulation within a process). A map of how anything that happens, happens.

Essence and personality — Essence is what you were born with — your real nature, genuinely yours. Personality is everything added from outside: learned behaviors, borrowed opinions, installed ambitions. In

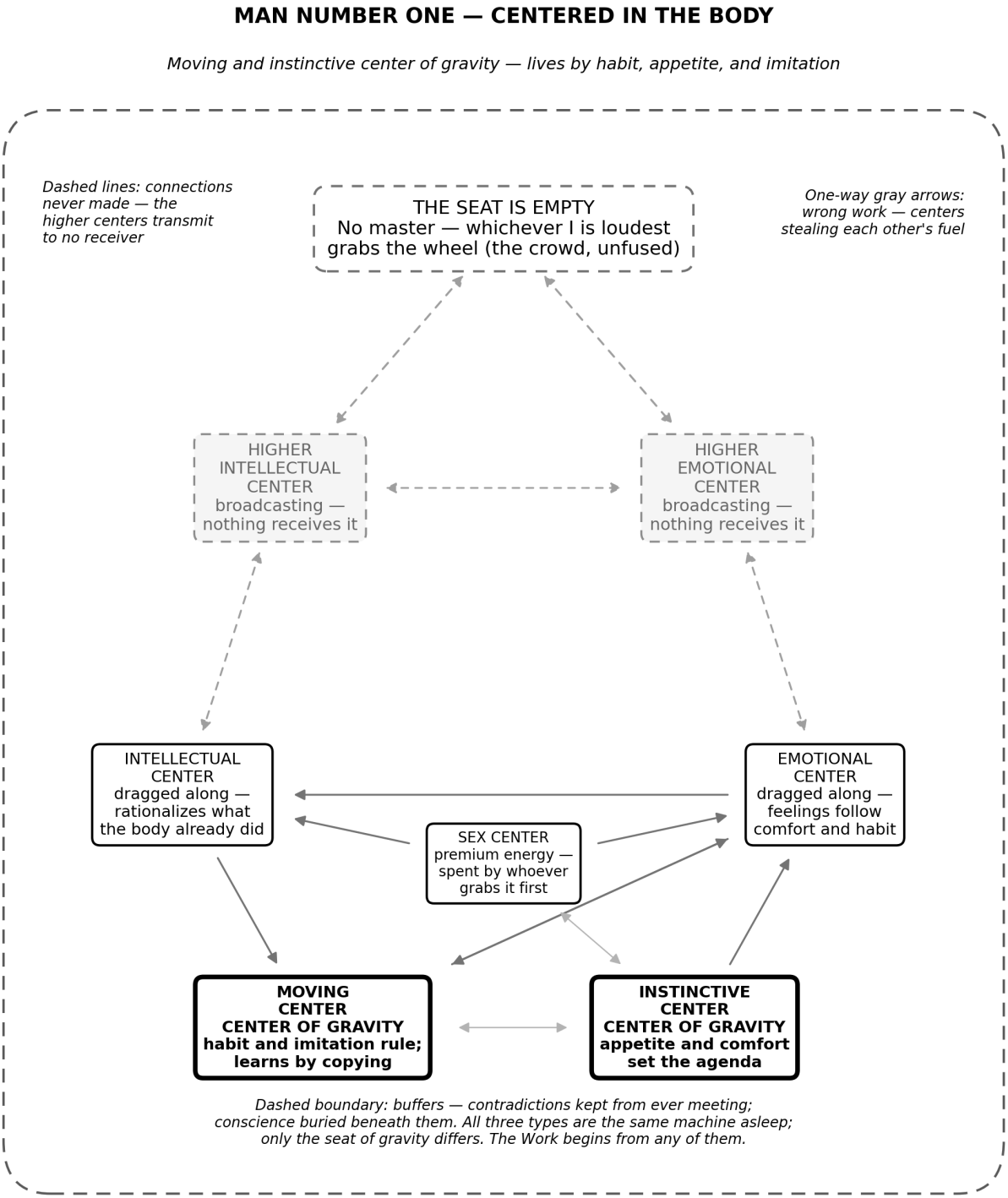


Figure 1: Man number one — centered in the body

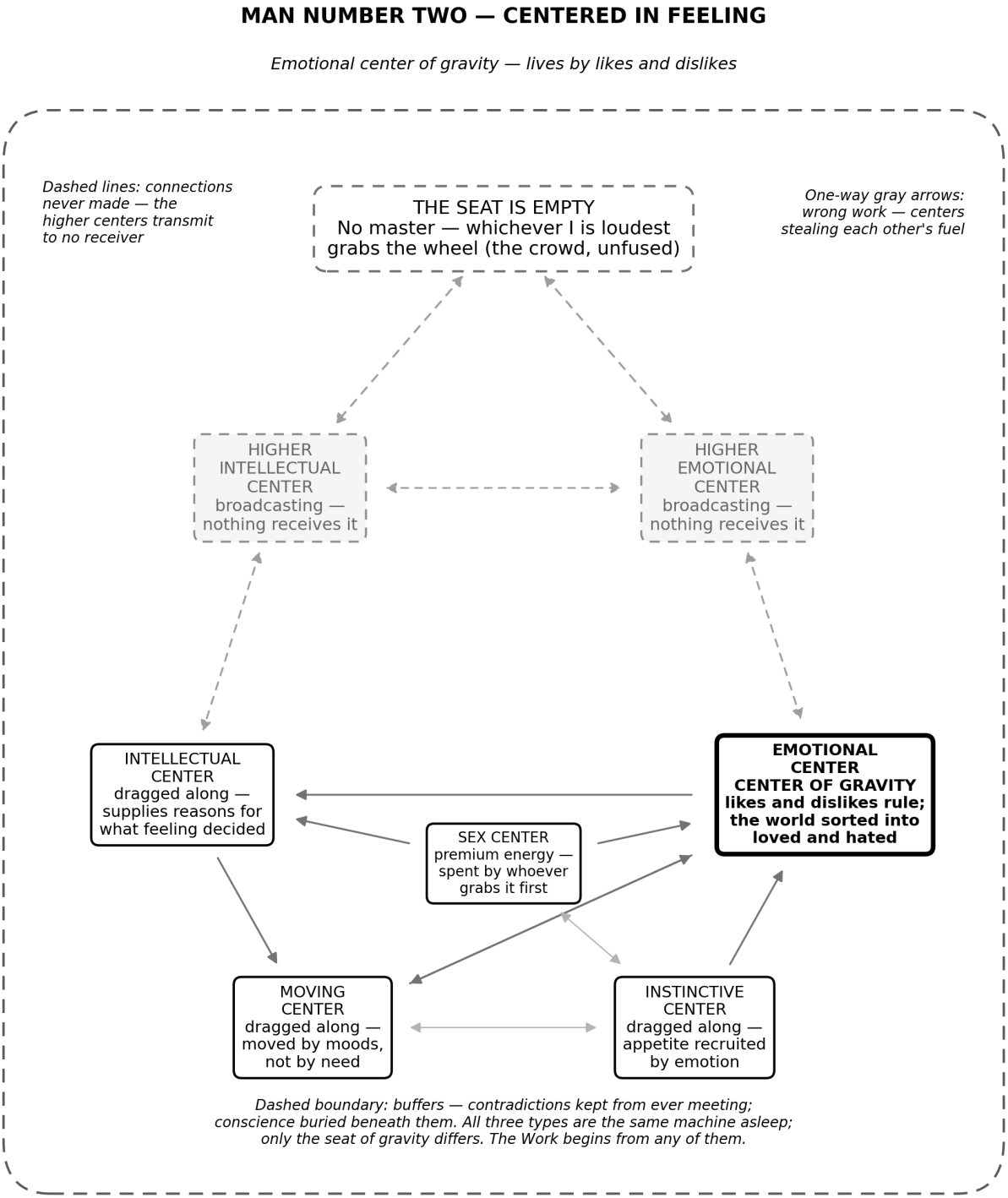


Figure 2: Man number two — centered in feeling

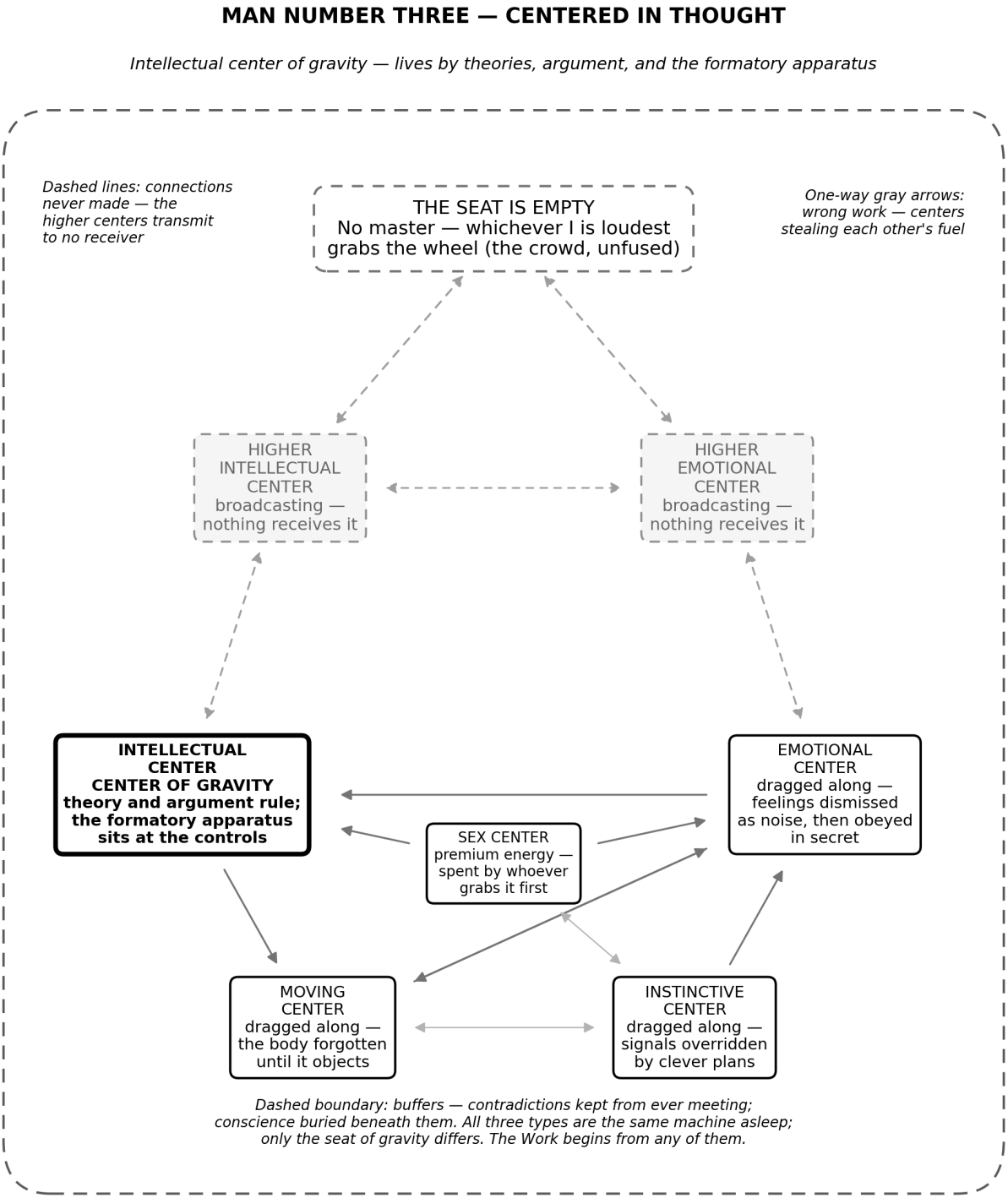


Figure 3: Man number three — centered in thought

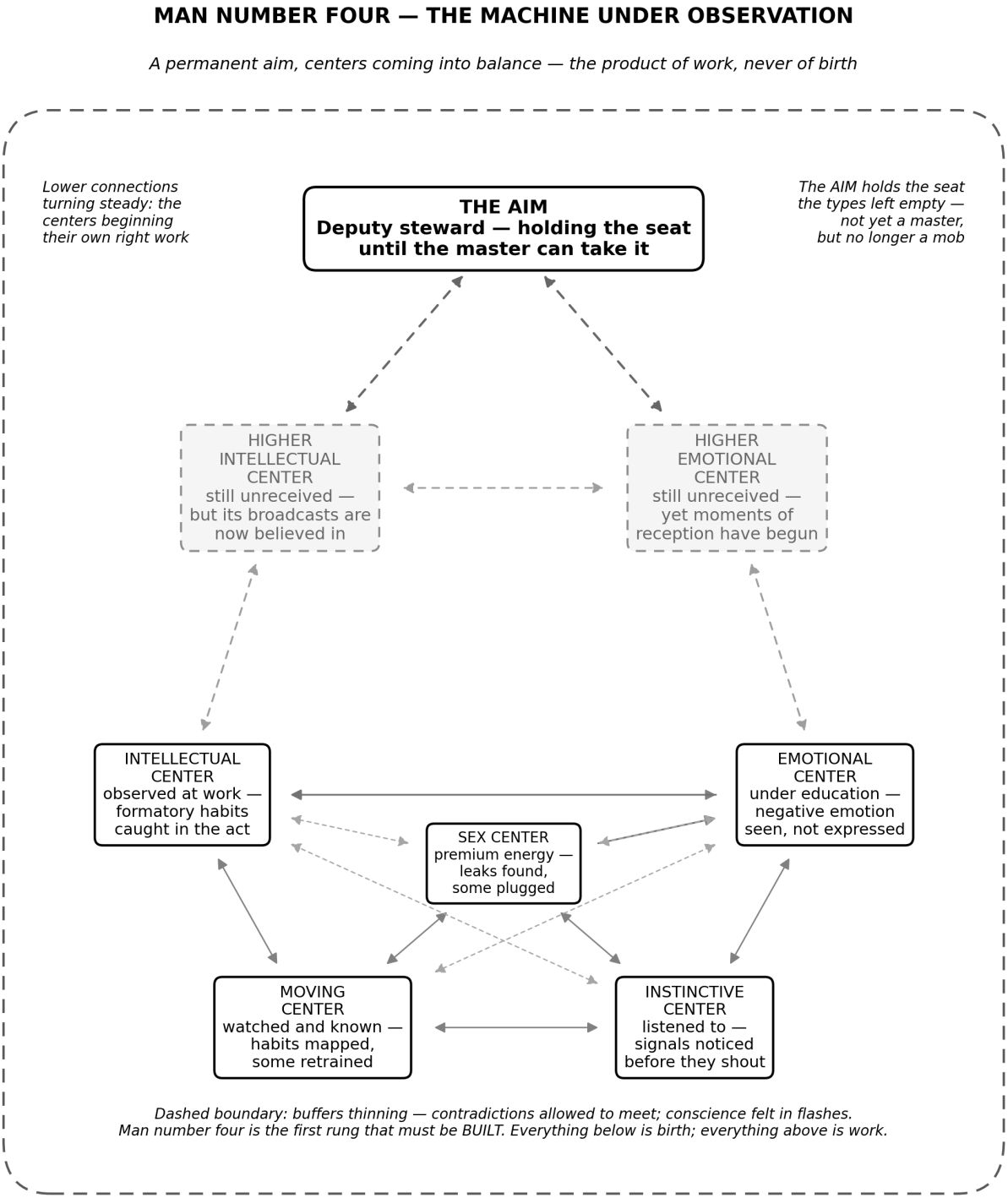


Figure 4: Man number four — the machine under observation

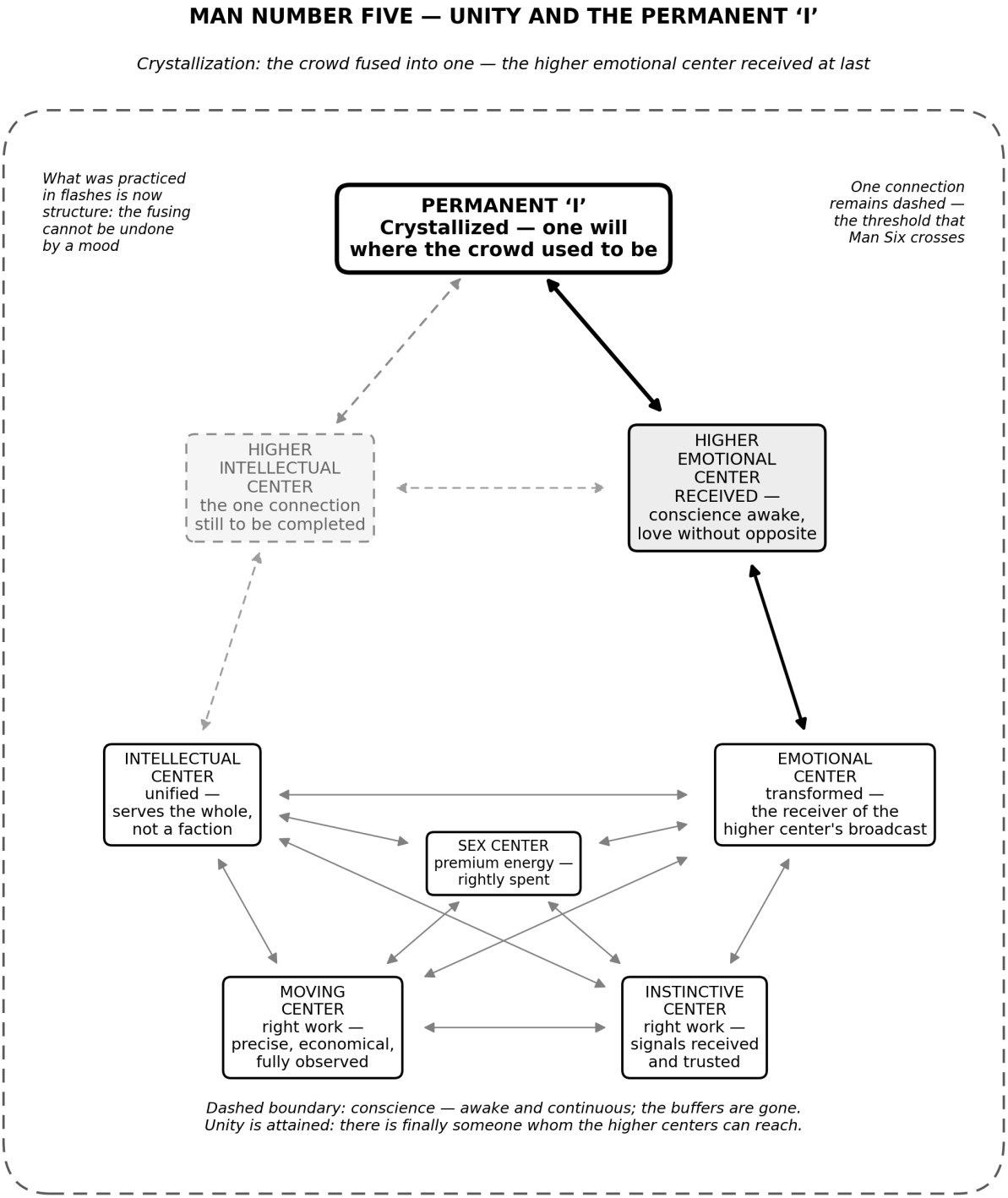


Figure 5: Man number five — unity and the permanent ‘I’

MAN NUMBER SIX — THE THRESHOLD

Objective consciousness: both higher centers received — everything of man number seven, except permanence

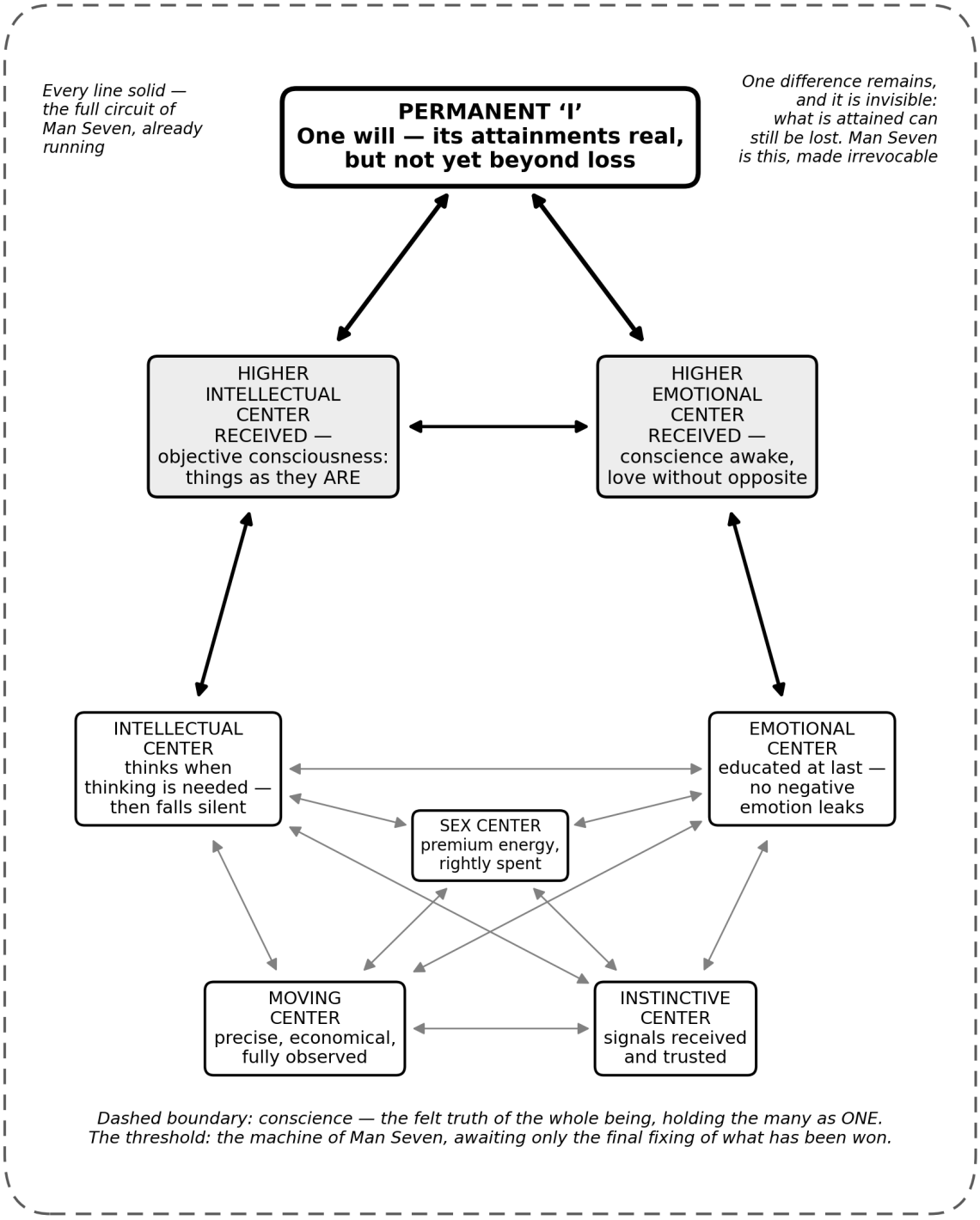


Figure 6: Man number six — the threshold

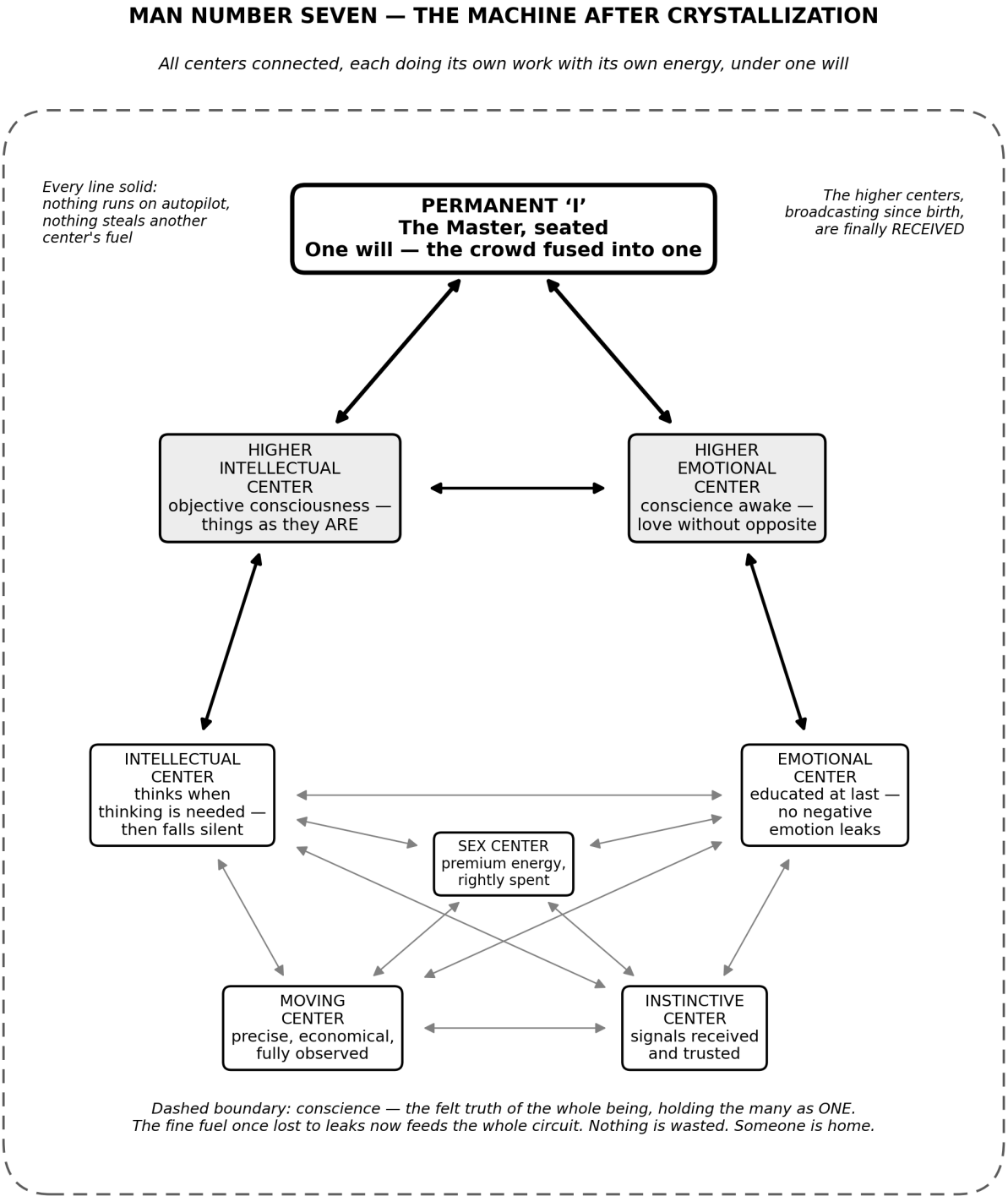


Figure 7: Man number seven — the machine after crystallization

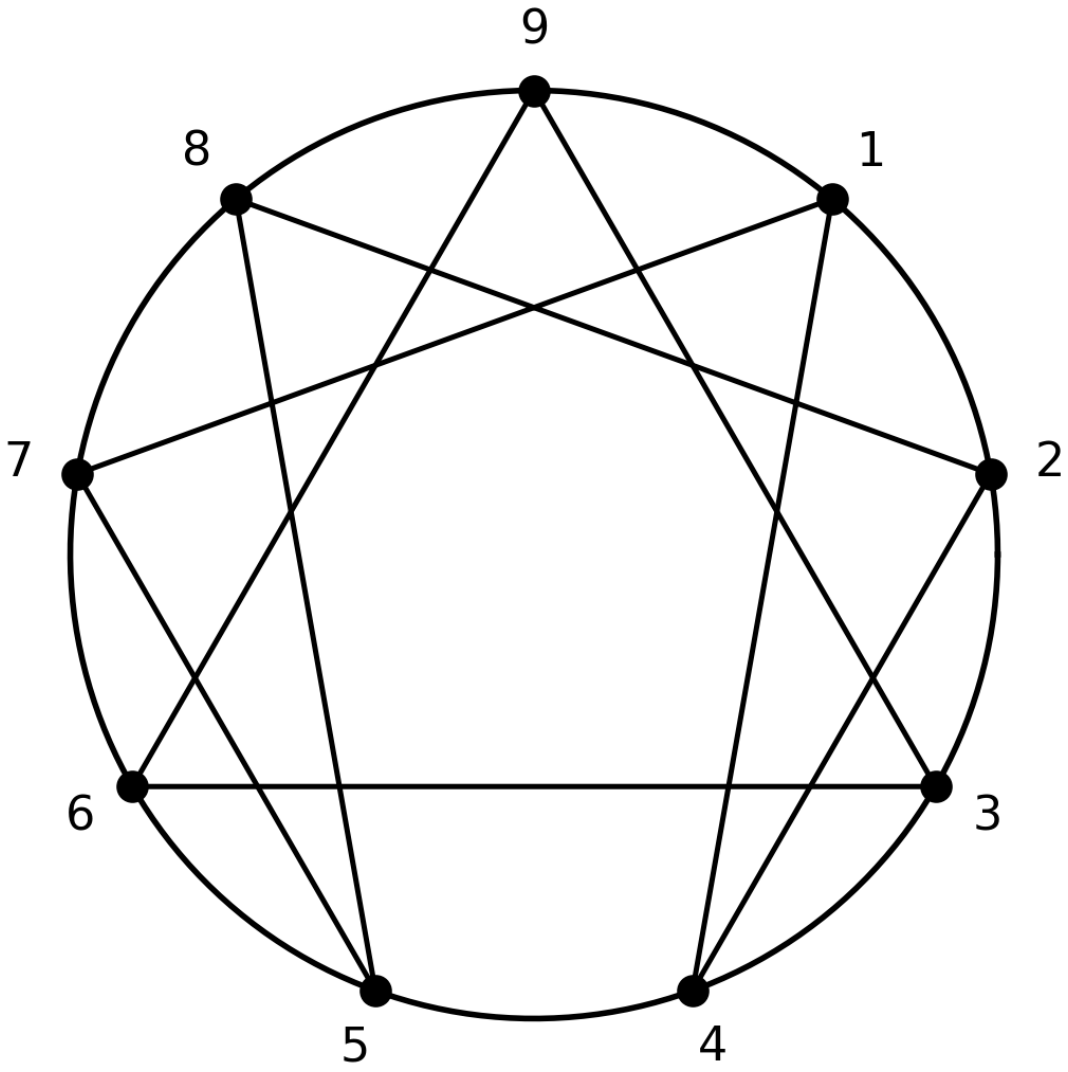


Figure 8: The enneagram: circle, triangle, and hexad

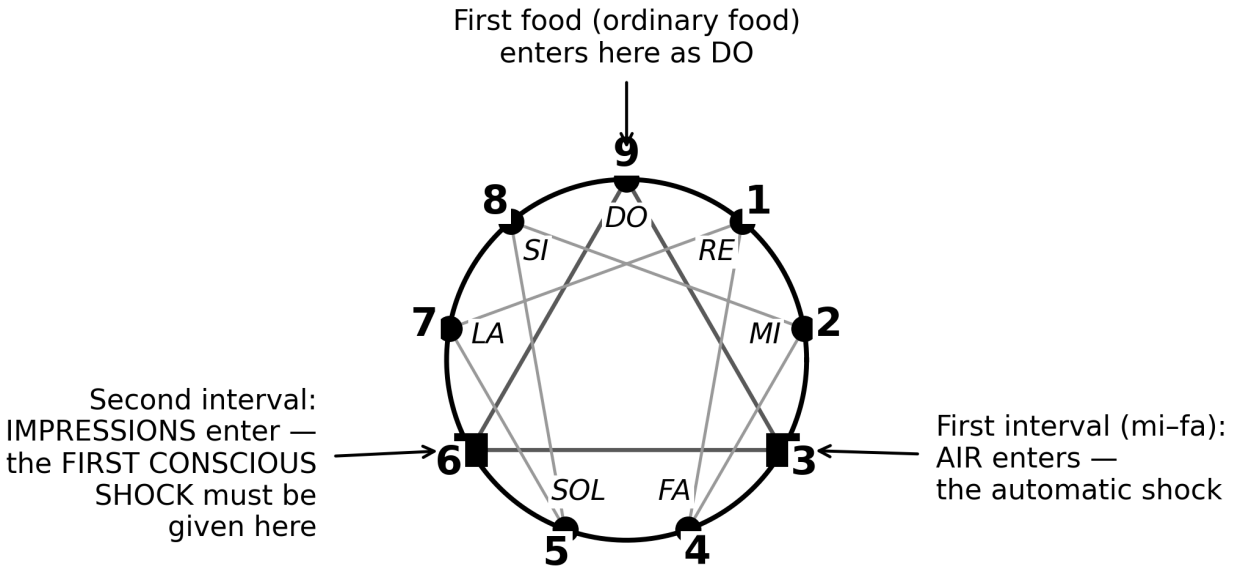


Figure 9: The food octave on the enneagram

most people, essence stops growing in early childhood while personality takes over; the Work's goal is to grow the essence using what personality accumulated.

External considering — Deliberate attention on another person's actual situation, from inside their life. The cure for internal considering, and the Work's name for empathy practiced as a discipline.

First conscious shock — Self-remembering applied at the exact moment an impression enters. Multiplies the fine energy the refinery extracts from experience. The central act of the Work.

Formatory apparatus — The moving part of the intellectual center: the mind's cache-and-retrieval system. Serves stored phrases, opinions, and labels instantly, with no thinking involved. Signatures: instant delivery and binary sorting.

Four states of consciousness — The Work's formal map: sleep (nighttime), waking sleep (ordinary life — the machine running with no one present), self-consciousness (presence, self-remembering), and objective consciousness (things perceived as they are). The third state is the only doorway to the fourth.

The Fourth Way — Gurdjieff's method for waking up inside ordinary life — no monastery, no renunciation. Works on all three centers at once, begins from understanding rather than obedience, and uses life's friction as its gymnasium.

Higher centers — The higher emotional and higher intellectual centers: already complete and functioning in everyone, broadcasting continuously at a fineness the noisy lower centers cannot receive. The Work is noise abatement, not construction.

Identification — The ordinary state in which attention fuses completely with its object and the sense of self disappears into the experience. One arrow, pointing outward. It feels like nothing at all — that is its signature.

Impressions — The third and finest food of the machine: everything that enters through the senses and awareness. Can be received (digested at full yield) or merely ingested (barely digested at all).

Intentional suffering — Voluntarily bearing what you would normally escape — others' unpleasant manifestations, the sting of non-justification, unavoidable pain consciously consented to — without expression, justification, or display. The practice of the second conscious shock.

Internal considering — Attention on other people in service of the self-image — the anxious inner accounting of your standing in their eyes. Never helpful; one of the heaviest drains in the psyche.

Intervals — The two structural gaps in every octave (mi–fa and si–do) where a process cannot continue on its own momentum and must receive a shock — or bend, stall, or die.

Knowledge, being, and understanding — Knowledge is what a person has learned; being is what a person IS. Either can outgrow the other (the brilliant fool; the stupid saint). Understanding is their product — it grows only when both grow, which is why this teaching cannot be merely studied.

Law of Octaves (Law of Seven) — Every process unfolds in stages like a musical scale, with two built-in gaps. Nothing proceeds in a straight line; every line bends at the intervals unless fresh force arrives there.

Law of Three — Nothing happens without three forces: one that pushes (first force), one that resists (second force), and one that relates them (third force). Where you see only two forces, you have deadlock — or a third force you haven't seen.

The machine — The human organism considered as what it observably is before awakening: a very capable apparatus that runs the whole of an ordinary life automatically, with no one required to be present.

Magnetic center — The inner compass formed by accumulated traces of B influences — everything that ever whispered "there is something more than this" — which steers a person toward the teaching. In Bennett's telling it doesn't retire on arrival: it matures into the living faculty of recognizing the genuine, in teachings and in oneself. Fed by sincerity and real need, not curiosity.

Man numbers one through seven — The scale of human types and development. Numbers one, two, and three (moving-instinctive, emotional, intellectual) are the born types, all equally asleep. Numbers four through seven mark real stages of development: self-remembering taken root, permanent center of gravity, access to higher centers, and full perfection.

Many "I"s — The Work's discovery that there is no single permanent "I" running a life — only a crowd of hundreds of partial I's taking turns at the controls, each calling itself "me" while on stage. A resolution made by one I cannot bind the others.

Negative emotion — Irritation, resentment, self-pity, anxiety, offense, and their family. In this teaching: not natural, not necessary, serving no function — learned leaks that burn the finest fuel the refinery produces.

Non-expression — The practice of not discharging negative emotion outward — while also not suppressing it, but observing it fully. The first stage of work on negative emotion.

Parts of centers — Each center divides into a moving part (autopilot), an emotional part (runs on interest), and an intellectual part (runs on deliberate attention). Nine compartments in the three main centers — and the division continues fractally below that.

Presence — The direct path's word for the state the Work calls self-remembering: actually being here for your own experience.

Second conscious shock — The transformation, at the octave's upper interval, of the very energy of reaction — suffering received with complete presence becomes the raw material of being. The frontier beyond the first shock.

Second line of work — Work with and for others on the same path — at minimum one partner for weekly plain-language reporting. Structural, not social: the external shock source and the mirror the machine cannot game.

Self-observation — Watching the machine's operations factually, without judgment and without trying to change anything — the Work's iron first step. Months of it precede any attempt at change.

Self-remembering — Attention flowing two ways at once: toward the world AND toward the one attending. Both arrows, in the same moment. The center of the entire Fourth Way.

Shock — Fresh force of the right kind arriving at an interval, allowing an octave to continue true. Every shock is a triad forming at a gap: third force arriving where the structure demands it.

Sleep — The ordinary waking condition: the machine running the whole of life competently while attention is absent and no one is home. Not a metaphor — the technical name for the state the ten-minute experiment reveals.

Sly man — Gurdjieff's name for the Fourth Way practitioner: not dishonest but efficient — using precise knowledge of the machine to produce with a fraction of the effort what brute discipline cannot produce at all.

The Stop — On a signal, total arrest of posture, expression, and thought for ten to thirty seconds while attention floods the frozen frame. The machine caught red-handed.

Three foods — The machine's three inputs: ordinary food (coarsest), air, and impressions (finest). All three are actual nutrition; only the first two are digested automatically.

The Work — The teaching and practice of the Fourth Way as a whole — the path of waking up inside ordinary life.